

SOLIDLab Flanders - Perspectives on Business Models and Ways Forward

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Sofie Verbrugge



**More than 5 million Flemish citizens
actively share personal data today**

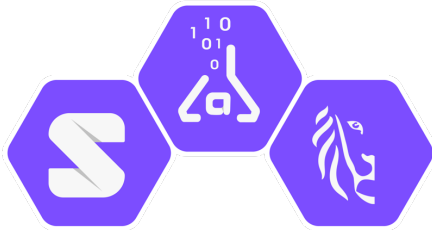
**73% of them
have a feeling of lacking control over their personal data**

The Solid community is investing heavily in
personal data ecosystem architectures

but **lacks evidence-based insight into what business models
actually work, and why promising deployments stall**

SolidLab Flanders delved into this

SolidLab Flanders (2022–2026)



interdisciplinary research

technical part

societal impact part

business and governance models

imec



KU LEUVEN

athumi



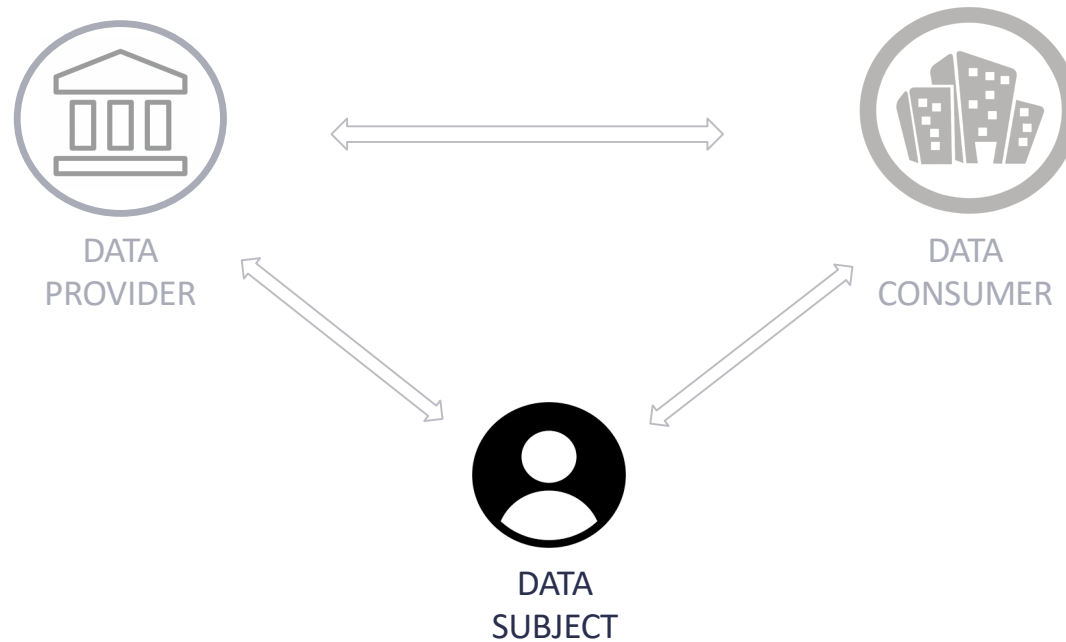
lead business model research

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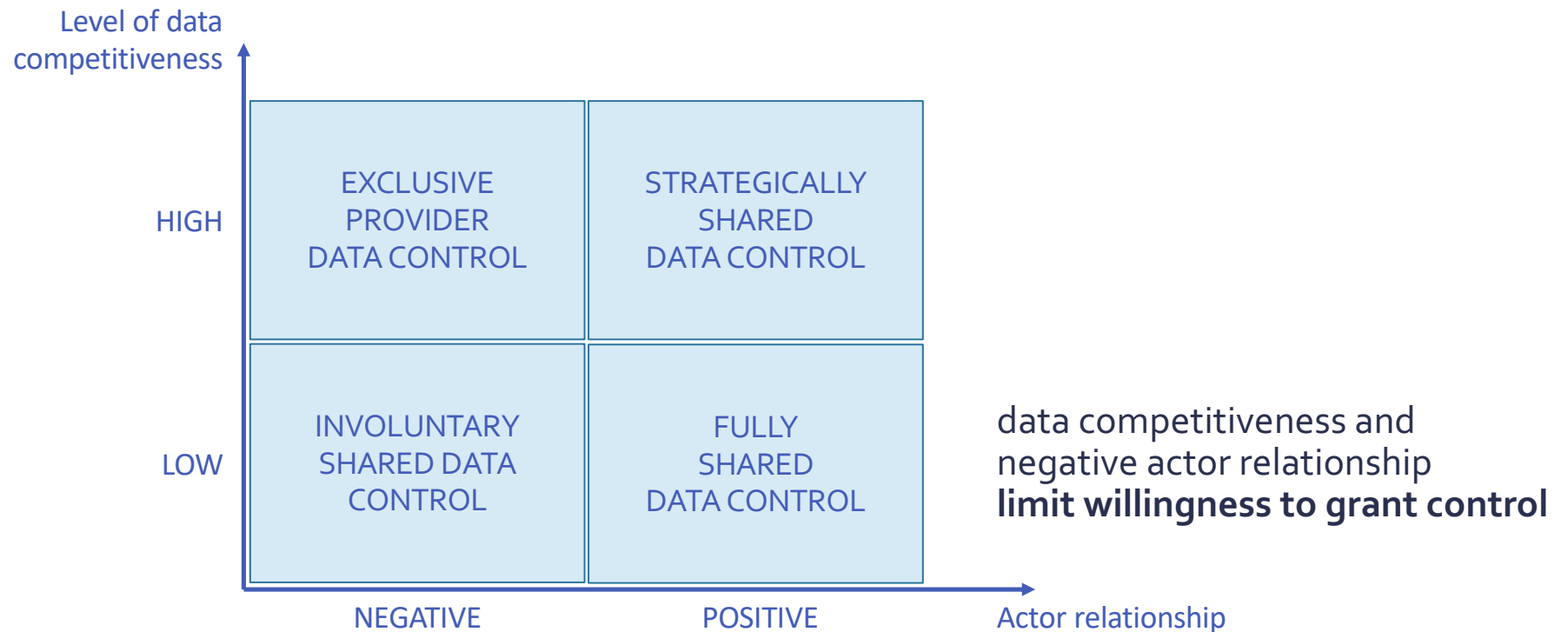
techno-economics





Solid and personal data ecosystems promise citizen data control
but **structural tensions in roles, governance and competitive dynamics**
determine whether that promise can be kept

Not all control will be granted to data subjects

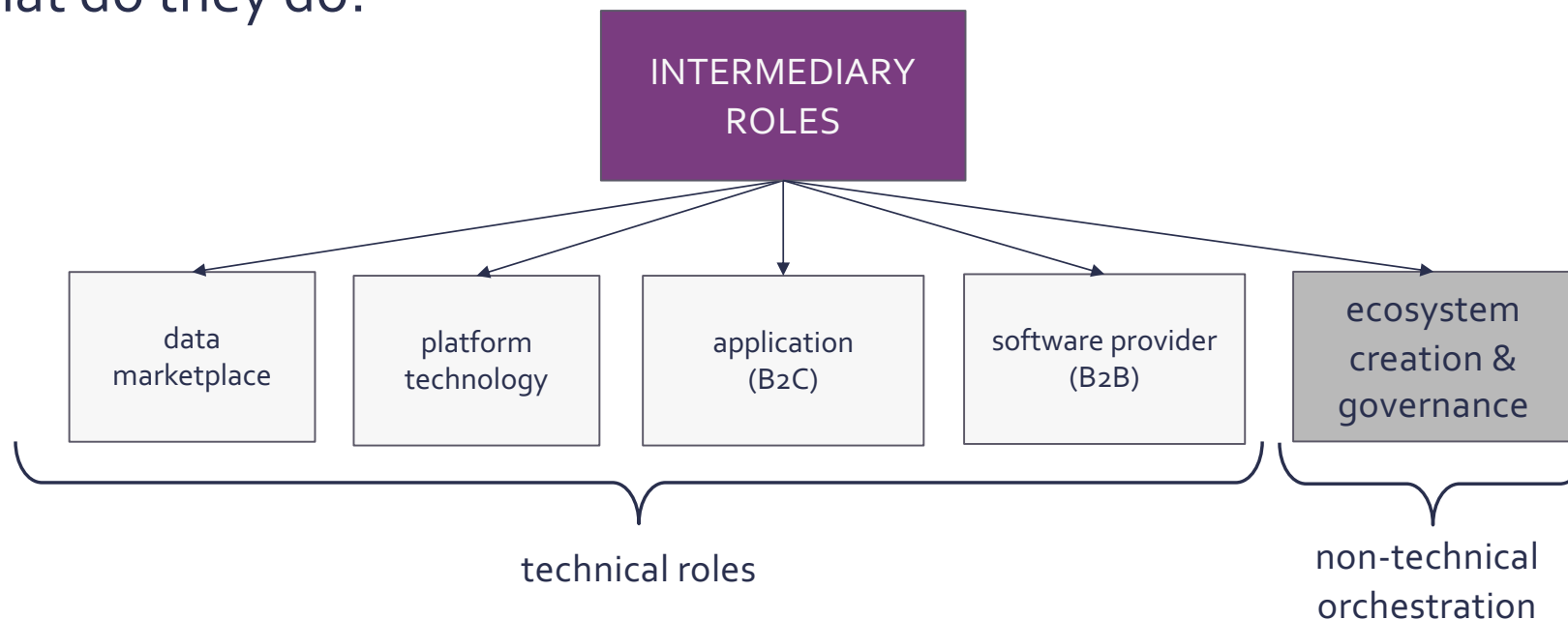


Intermediaries are indispensable but diverse

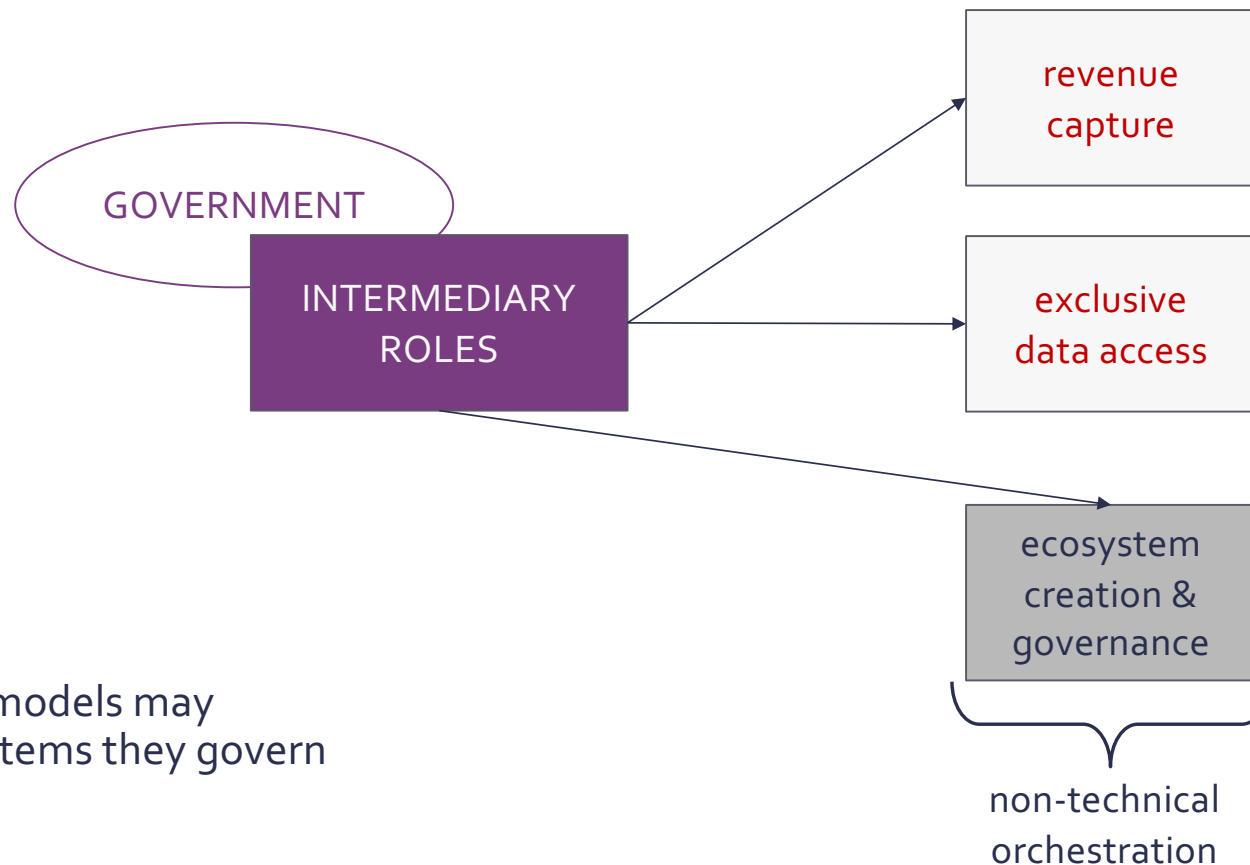
Who do they face?

data subject, company, both

What do they do?

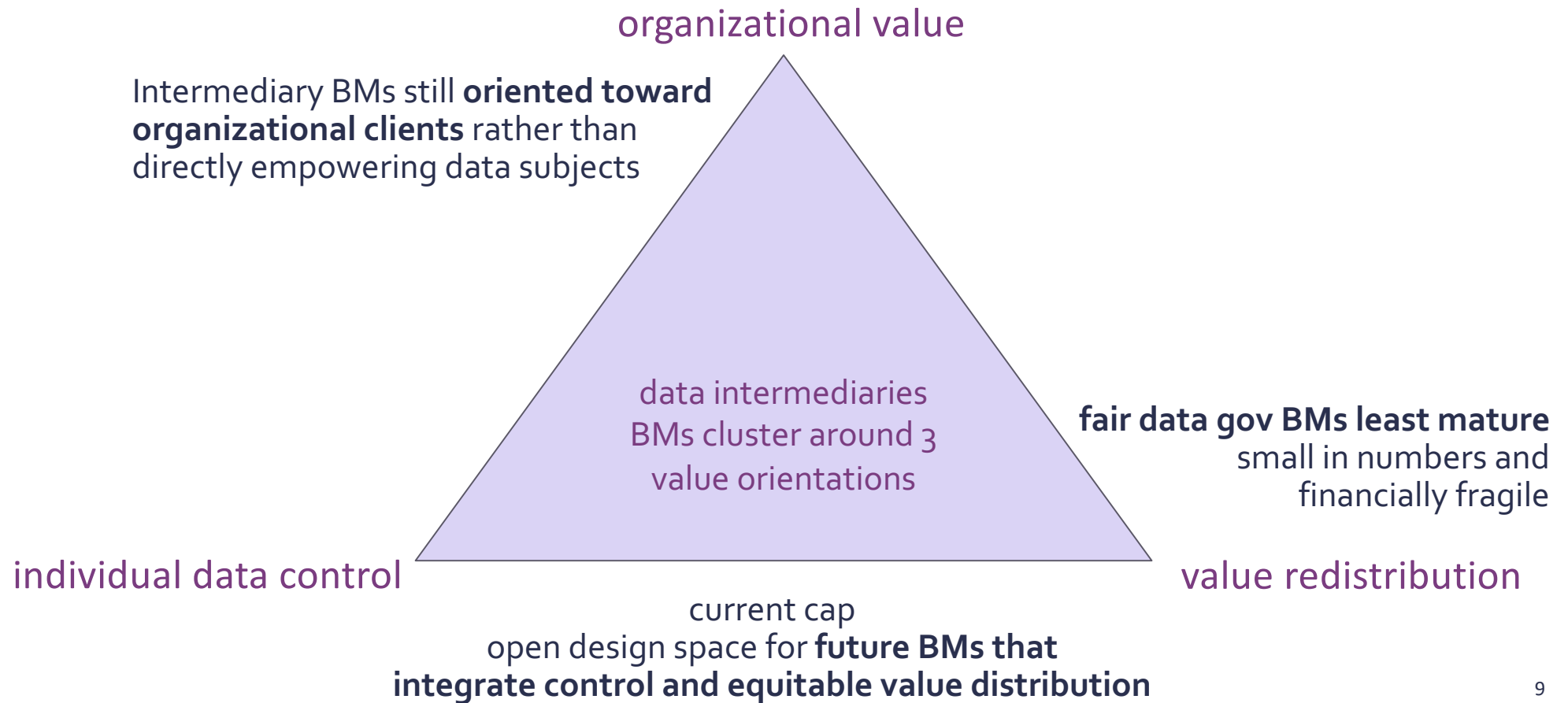


Intermediaries are indispensable but diverse

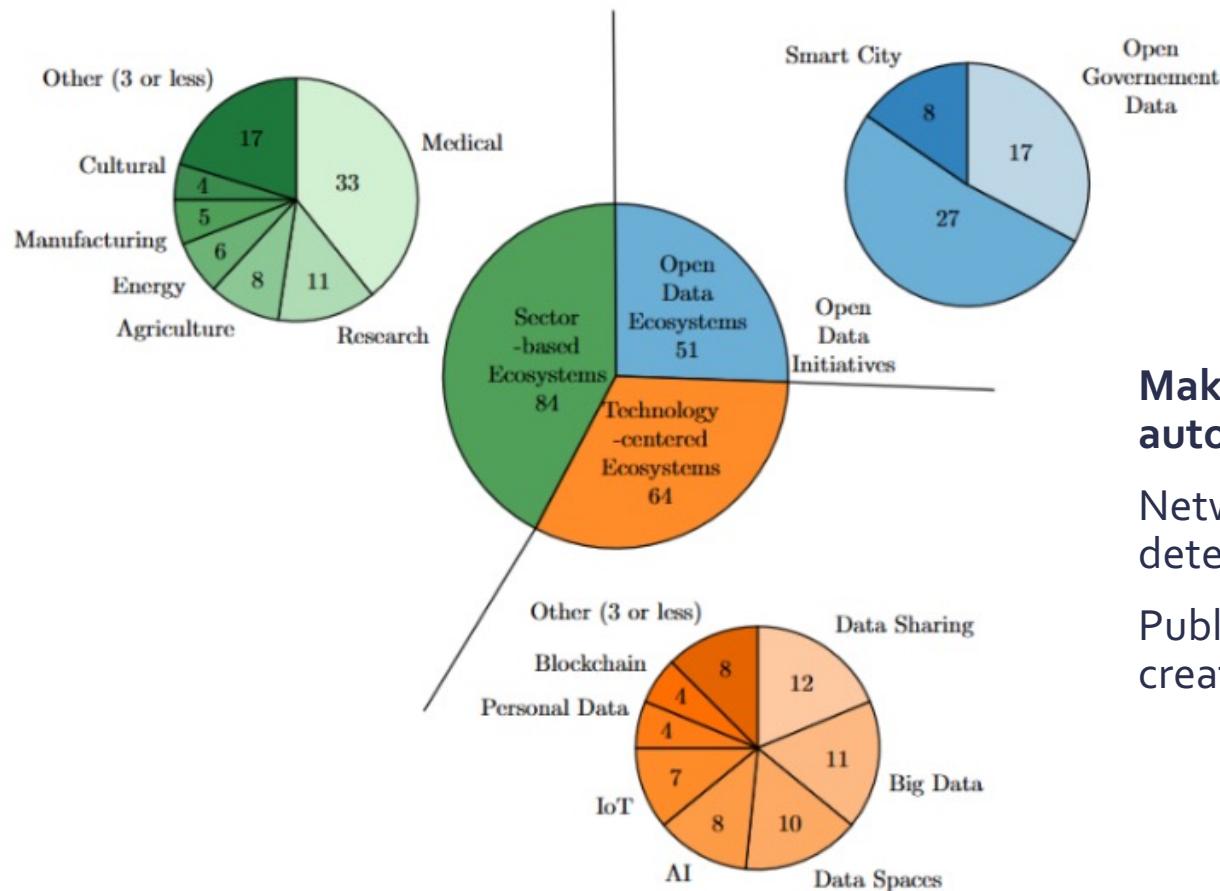


GovTech capture models may undermine ecosystems they govern

Data intermediary business models



Network effects and cases determine viability



Making more data available does not automatically lead to more data sharing

Network effects and concrete use cases determine value creation

Public funding is critical (cross-domain) but creates dependency once it ends

Solid value from service provider perspective

Affordances: relationship between users and technological features they interact with to achieve a business goal

decentralization

less important for companies now
sovereignty, lock-in avoidance

legalities

transparency

validity

strong secondary drivers for Solid
risk reduction (compliance and trust)

personalisation

collaboration

automation

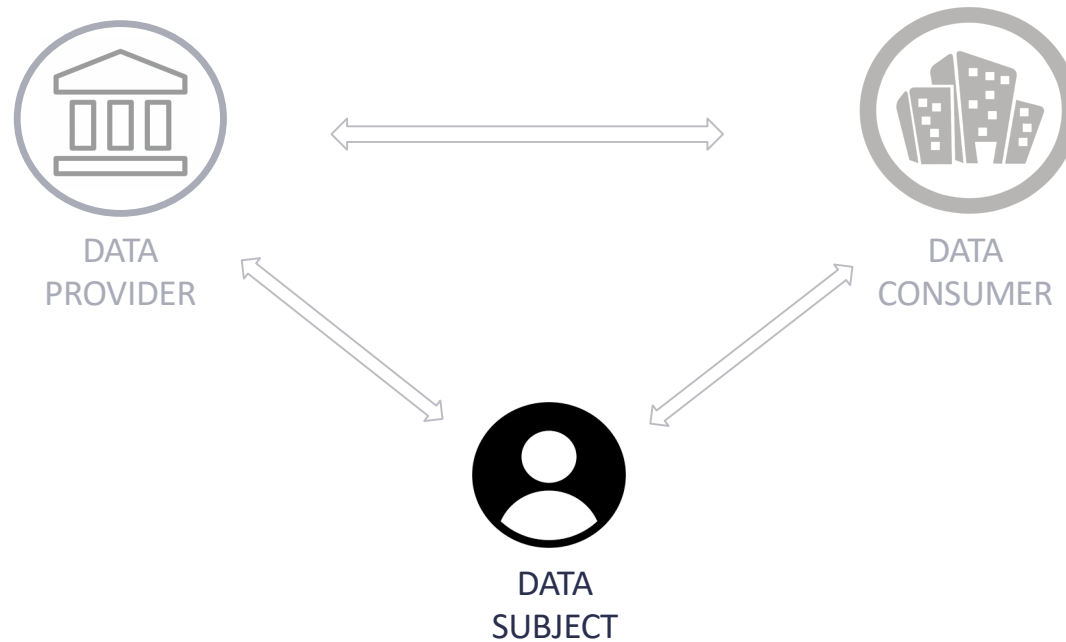
interoperability

enabled by Solid now
direct value drivers

Service providers adopt Solid for actual **efficiency gains and risk reduction** rather than ideology

Personal data ecosystems and Solid adoption face limitations

- willingness to grant data control to data subject
- maturity of BMs aimed at value and control redistribution
- structural tensions in intermediary roles
- ecosystem scale
- perceived value of sovereignty



Solid and personal data ecosystems justly promise citizen data control
but still **face tensions in roles, competitive dynamics and
balancing data control with fair value distribution**

More than 5 Million Flemish citizens share data. 73% of them have a feeling of lacking control over their personal data.

**Solid has the potential to solve these issues
but BM tensions remain to be resolved**

References

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Thank you!

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